nearly the whole of the day, knocking about the ministers ante-room he being engaged and not to be seen, in the meanwhile the printers are waiting and the Gazette must come out on Thursday morning. This gives me great vexation and trouble. One mistake, which has made the minister so cautious was the official announcement in the Gazette of the appointment of a general to the command of eight battalions of infantry before the apointment had taken place! The fact was that the minister who was an intimate friend of the general's had asked the King for the place, the King had given an undecided answer in the mean time the commission was drawn out backed by the minister and only waiting the King's signature. One of the ministers secretaries thinking the thing already finished sent a copy of the commission to me for publication. I thinking all was regular published the thing, the King was out of town and did not get his paper until the evening. Looking it over at night he saw an appointment he had never appointed, got in a fury with his minister and sent him several very sharp notes, in the morning there was enquiry and it was near going hard with me, but I believe the King soon found out who was to blame, and I heard no more about the matter — the general never got his regiments.

One of my old friends [among] the American missionaries settled at Ouroumia has introduced the American Sea Island cotton[130] and some other species. It has answered well in north of Persia and last spring my above named friend, the Revd Mr Stocking[131] sent me some of the seed to present to the King. H. M. ordered me to distribute it, publish the manner of cultivation and write it up in the paper, this I did and from the accounts I have received it appears to be thriving wonderfully; this will be a great benefit to the people, so you see that altho' I only make a bare living myself I am doing some good for my fellow men and my work is not in vain.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, February 21, 1854*

Our dear Father will perhaps have informed you, if I have not written to you, that our child Johnny died on the *3rd* Decr this as you may suppose has caused great grief to us particularly to Anna; and altho' I have not felt the loss so acutely as my wife yet when a man arrives at my time of life and has but one child and that child is taken away from him, he feels the deprivation deeply.

Dr Cormick, with whom you were acquainted in England, and who married my wifes younger sister has been here since last October; his appointment is properly at Tabreez as physician to the Governor of the province, but he was ordered here last autumn and since his arrival has performed some very good

130 One of the many projects of the American missionaries at Urumia.

131 Rev. W. R. Stocking, early associated with Dr. Perkins in the American mission at Urumia.

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